




Measure Z:

Addressing Safety & Educational Priorities in Our Schools

Community Presentation

Visalia UNIFIED SCHOOL DISTRICT



Our Mission:
Every Student Learning Every Day

Our Vision:
Every Student Empowered to Achieve Future Success

Visalia Unified Foundations

Mission | Vision | Beliefs | Commitments | Plan

Core Beliefs and Commitments

All students can achieve at high levels and demonstrate continuous growth
- Providing high-quality learning experiences that allow all students to reach their fullest potential
- Equipping students and staff with the educational tools necessary for achievement and growth

Family and community engagement is key to student success
- Providing families and community members pathways of connectivity to the education system
- Facilitating timely and consistent communication to position families to participate in their students' learning experiences

Learning environments should be safe, supportive, and innovative
- Ensuring all students are known by their name, welcomed each day, and connected to meaningful activities
- Designing learning environments that drive innovative practices to improve student outcomes
- Providing all students the academic and social supports needed to be successful
- Creating physical and social-emotional safety in all learning environments

Commitment for Student Learning

If we...

- ✓ Continually improve processes and systems
- ✓ Ensure a strong foundation for all learners
- ✓ Empower teachers and staff
- ✓ Have a high quality, professionally trained workforce
- ✓ Ensure equitable allocation of resources
- ✓ Facilitate pathways of connectivity

...then we will ensure the success of each and every student.

Visalia Unified Forward 2030
VUSD Strategic & Facilities Plan

High Expectations, High Achievement
Empowering Students, Engaging Families & Community
Organizational Efficiency & Effectiveness

I believe in, I belong in...*I am VUSD*

Measure Z Bond Update

Providing clear, factual information to our staff and community

- **Previous bonds:** What did Measures E and A accomplish, and how were those funds managed?
- **Current commitments:** What Measure A projects and high school investments remain?
- **Planning for the future:** How have three years of facilities and enrollment planning shaped our priorities?
- **Measure Z projects:** What improvements would the measure fund if approved?
- **Taxpayer impact:** How does VUSD's bond tax rate compare with neighboring districts?

Our Guiding Principles



Address critical infrastructure needs

Prioritize essential systems such as roofs, HVAC, and aging portable classrooms

Prioritize modernization of existing schools

Upgrade learning environments to support current and future instructional needs

Balance enrollment across schools

Align school enrollment with school site capacity

Address community growth

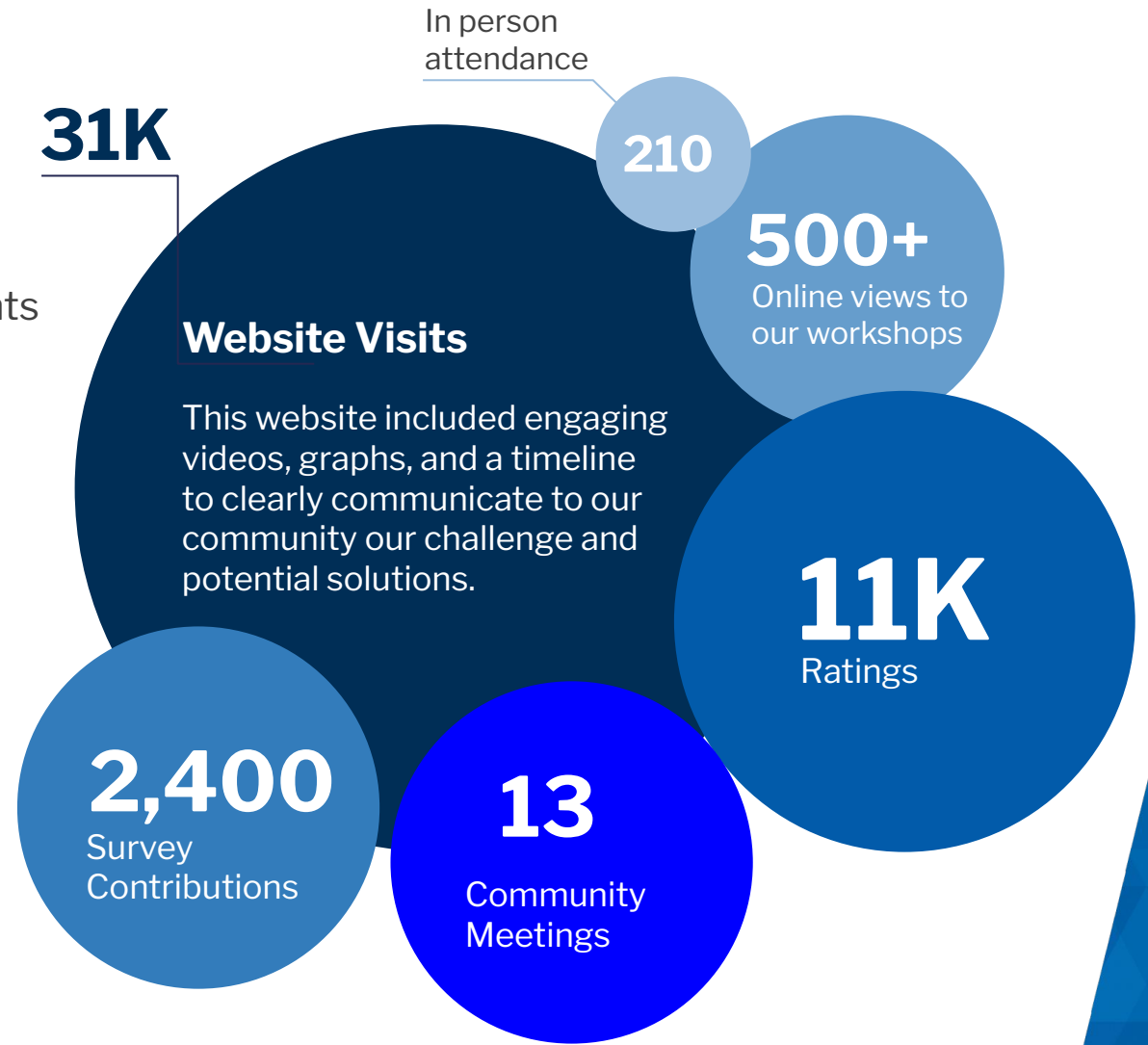
NW and SE continue to experience residential development

Be fiscally responsible

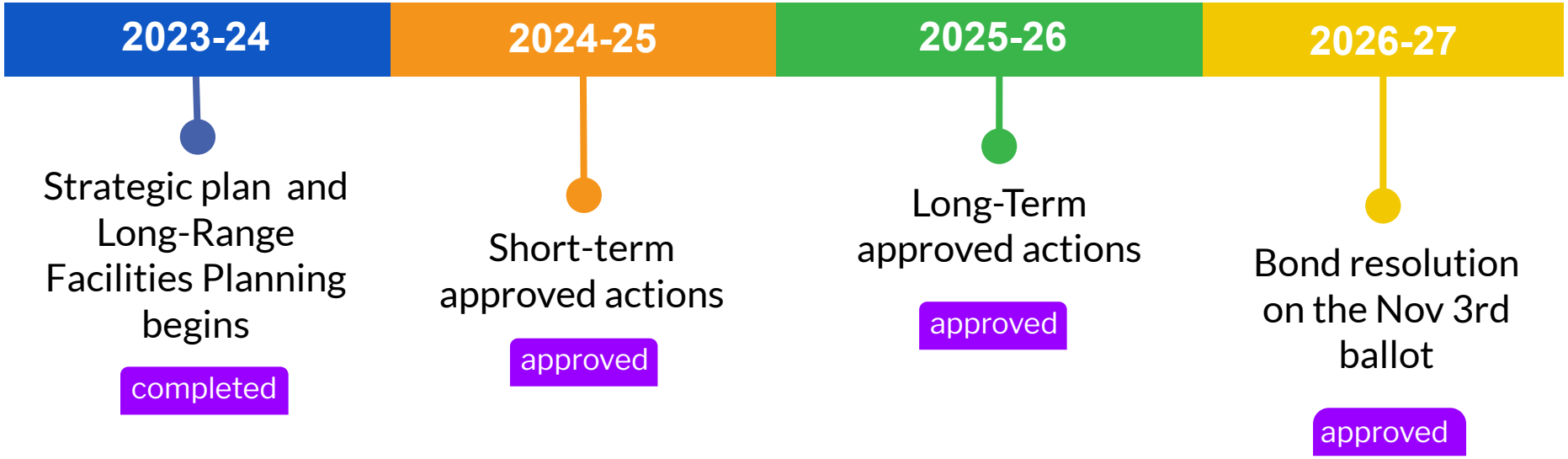
Ensure investments align with future needs of the District

Transparent Process - 2 Years of Community Engagement

- **Website**
  Over 31,000 visits
- **ThoughtExchange**
  Over 11,000 ratings of community thoughts
- **Surveys -**
  Over 2,400 contributions
- **Online Workshop Video -**
  Over 500 views
- **In-Person Workshops -**
  200+ total individuals attended



Our journey towards equitable education



What Previous Bond Measures Accomplished

Measure E Projects

- ✓ Ridgeview MS
- ✓ Redwood HS Academic Bldg.
- ✓ RHS Science Mod
- ✓ GWHS Mod
- ✓ Mineral King Mod
- ✓ Ivanhoe Mod
- ✓ Goshen Mod
- ✓ Solar @ Various Sites
- ✓ Playgrounds @ Various Sites
- ✓ Golden West Music Bldg.
- ✓ Crowley Mod
- ✓ Washington Mod

Measure A Projects

- ✓ MWHS Gym
- ✓ MWHS Science
- ✓ Valley Oak Science & Tech Package
- ✓ Green Acres Science & Tech Package
- ✓ La Joya Science & Tech Package
- ✓ Divisadero Science & Tech Package
- ✓ Safety and Security (All Sites)

Projects in Development

- ❑ Houston Modernization
- ❑ Veva Blunt Modernization
- ❑ Crestwood Modernization (design only)

Why isn't the district building a new high school?

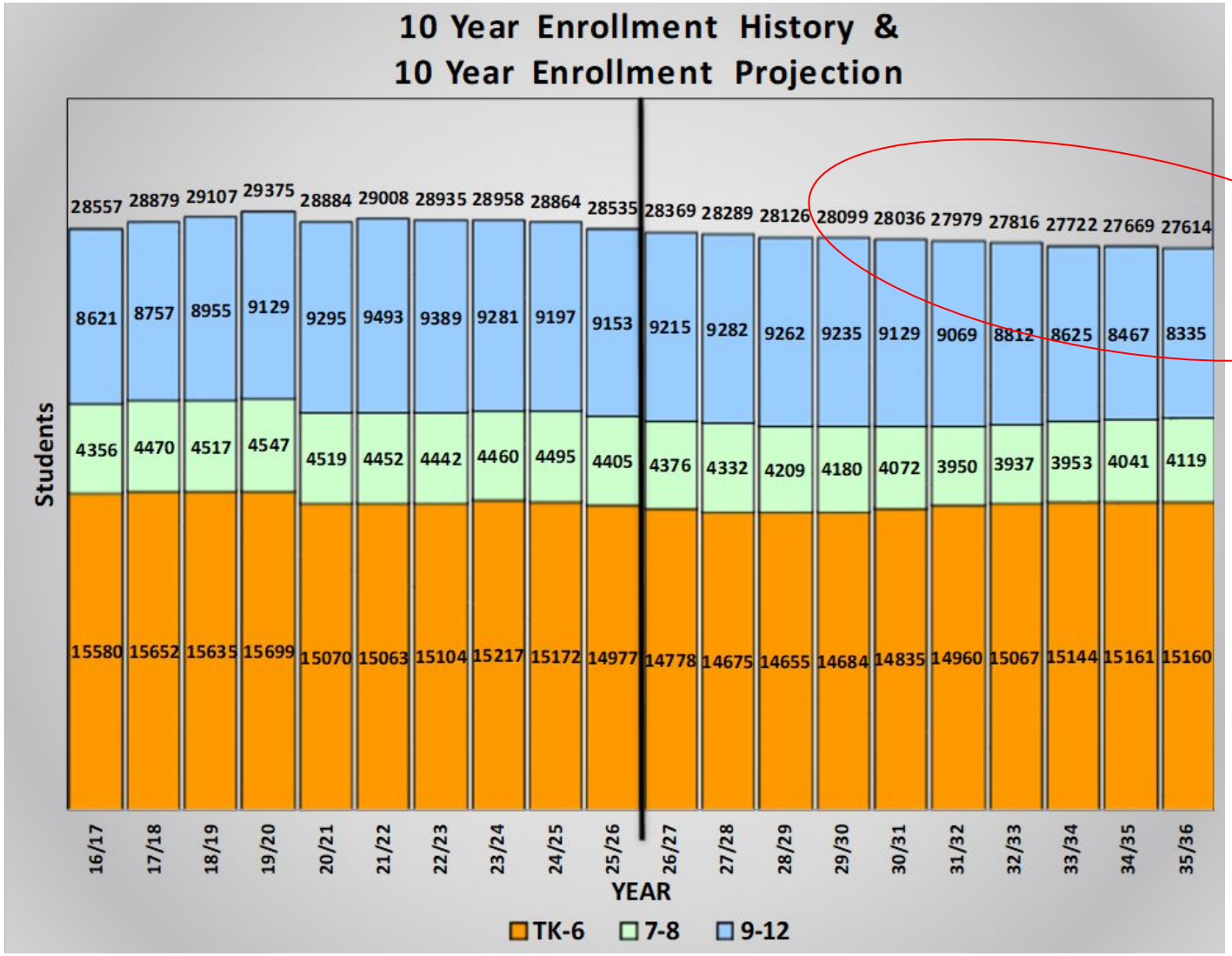
10-Year Enrollment Projections

2025-26 = 28,535

2035-36 = 27,614

921 fewer students

818 in high school



Measure A: Remaining Project Commitments

Veva Blunt Elementary

- Campus modernization

Mt. Whitney High School

- New academic building
- Classroom replacement and modernization—16 classrooms

El Diamante High School

- New classroom building—6 classrooms

Redwood High School

- New classroom building—8 classrooms

Protecting Taxpayer Investment 3 Ways



1. Independent annual financial & performance audits
2. Citizens Oversight Committee & public reporting
3. Bond funds can only be used for school facilities, not salaries or operating expenses

VUSD.org > Divisions > Business Services > Internal Auditor > Audit Reports > scroll down to see all Measure A & E Financial and Performance Audits

INDEPENDENT AUDITOR'S REPORT

Board of Education
Visalia Unified School District
Visalia, California

Report on the Audit of the Financial Statements

Opinion

We have audited the financial statements of the Measure A General Obligation Bonds (the "Bonds") activity of Visalia Unified School District (the "District"), as of and for the year ended June 30, 2025, and the related notes to the financial statements, as listed in the table of contents.

In our opinion, the accompanying financial statements referred to above present fairly, in all material respects, the financial position of the Measure A General Obligation Bonds activity, of Visalia Unified School District, as of June 30, 2025, and the respective changes in its financial position for the year then ended in accordance with accounting principles generally accepted in the United States of America.

Board Bond Management Saves Taxpayers $156.9 million

Refinancing Measure E bonds and securing an improved credit rating and financing structure for Measure A bonds, reduced repayment costs.

Measure E	Measure A
$61.8 million less	$95.1 million less
Payments end **3 years earlier**	Payments end **7 years earlier**

$156.9 million in combined taxpayer savings

Compared with the original bond financing plans.

Measure Z Public Transparency Program

Keeping our Community Informed

If approved, Measure Z would build on existing independent oversight and audit requirements with:

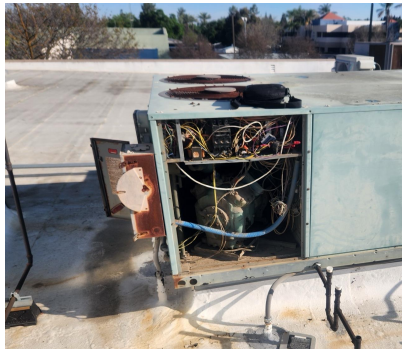
- **Quarterly Community Meetings**
  Share project plans, progress, proposed changes, and opportunities for questions.
- **Online Transparency Dashboard**
  Track project schedules, budgets, expenditures, and key decisions.
- **Annual Reports Published Locally**
  Summarize completed work, spending, and upcoming priorities.

Clear information about what is planned, what changes, and why.

Facility Assessment - Every building, every classroom









Priority 1	Priority 2
1-2 years	3-5 years
+$77M	+$105M
Priority 3	**Priority 4**
6-10 years	11+ years
+$98M	+$355M

$182 million in short-term needs

$636 million in total needs long-term

VUSD.org > Forward 2030 > Facilities Master Plan > scroll down to School Site Sections > click on school links

Bond Investment Priorities

If approved by voters, funding would support projects including:

- ✔ Remove hazardous materials like asbestos and lead pipes
- ✔ Continue to provide safe drinking water
- ✔ Upgrade older schools so they meet current health codes, building safety codes, and provide proper access for students with disabilities
- ✔ Repair or replace deteriorating roofs, plumbing, gas lines, sewer lines, HVAC and electrical systems
- ✔ Upgrade schools to prepare students for jobs and careers
- ✔ Upgrade classrooms, labs and technology to support high quality instruction in math, science, engineering, and technology

Over 380 roof leaks in 2024-25	**70% of schools over 50 years old**	**87% (430) of portable classrooms are over 20 yrs old**

Full Ballot Measure

To provide safe, modern schools by removing asbestos/lead pipes; continuing to provide safe drinking water; fixing deteriorating roofs, plumbing, HVAC, electrical systems; and repairing/ upgrading aging classrooms, labs, career technology and facilities to support student achievement and college/career readiness; **Shall Visalia Unified School District's measure authorizing $158,000,000 in bonds at legal rates be adopted,** levying 4 cents per $100 assessed value ($12,000,000 annually) while bonds are outstanding, with independent audits/oversight and all money locally controlled?

How our Bond tax rate compares to other local communities

Annual bond tax rate per $100,000 of assessed value



Why are modern spaces important?











I Believe in,
I Belong in,
I AM...
VUSD
Visalia Unified School District

Visalia Unified
Forward 2030
Strategic Plan

This is about more than buildings—it is about providing every student, regardless of the school they attend, with a high-quality education, because when they succeed, our community succeeds.

For more information visit **engage.vusd.org**

Use the QR code below to submit any questions you may have regarding Measure Z.

